

Part IX

Responsible AI, Academic Integrity, and Professional Conduct

"Artificial intelligence changes how we work. It does not change our responsibility for the quality, integrity, and consequences of our decisions."

Introduction

Artificial intelligence is transforming professional work across virtually every industry. Executives now use AI to analyze markets, evaluate competitors, summarize research, forecast demand, draft reports, generate strategic alternatives, and support organizational decision making. Consequently, responsible AI use has become an essential professional competency.

This course views AI neither as a prohibited technology nor as a substitute for independent thinking.

Instead, AI is treated as a strategic collaborator whose outputs must be evaluated critically, verified rigorously, and applied responsibly.

The purpose of this policy is to establish expectations that reflect the realities of modern professional practice while maintaining the highest standards of academic integrity and scholarly excellence.

Guiding Principles

Responsible use of AI throughout this course is guided by six principles.

Principle 1 — Human Judgment Remains Primary

Artificial intelligence can generate information, identify patterns, summarize literature, and propose strategic alternatives.

Only humans are responsible for strategic judgment.

Students remain accountable for every statement, recommendation, analysis, citation, and conclusion submitted in this course.

Principle 2 — Transparency Builds Trust

Professional organizations increasingly expect employees to disclose meaningful AI assistance.

Students are expected to acknowledge substantive AI use whenever AI materially contributes to:

- analysis,
- writing,
- editing,
- research synthesis,
- strategic recommendations,
- visualizations,
- presentations,
- or software development.

Transparency demonstrates professional integrity rather than weakness.

Principle 3 — Verification Is Required

Artificial intelligence occasionally produces inaccurate, incomplete, outdated, or fabricated information.

Students are expected to verify AI-generated material using:

- peer-reviewed scholarship,
- organizational reports,
- government publications,
- reputable industry analyses,
- financial statements,
- and other credible evidence.

Unverified AI output should never be treated as authoritative evidence.

Principle 4 — Scholarship Requires Attribution

Artificial intelligence is not a scholarly source.

Students should cite the original articles, books, reports, datasets, or organizational documents upon which their arguments rely.

AI may support the research process but should not replace scholarly engagement with the primary literature.

Principle 5 — Confidentiality Matters

Many organizations possess confidential information, proprietary strategies, customer data, or trade secrets.

Students should never upload confidential organizational information into public AI systems unless explicit authorization has been obtained and institutional policies permit such use.

Professional judgment includes protecting organizational information assets.

Principle 6 — Ethical Leadership Extends Beyond Compliance

Responsible AI involves more than following legal requirements.

Strategic leaders should evaluate:

- fairness,
- accountability,
- transparency,
- privacy,
- explainability,
- bias,
- human oversight,
- sustainability,
- and long-term stakeholder impact.

These considerations should inform every strategic recommendation developed during the course.

Appropriate Uses of Artificial Intelligence

Students are encouraged to use AI in ways that enhance learning and professional development.

Examples include:

- brainstorming strategic alternatives,
- generating discussion questions,
- comparing theoretical perspectives,
- summarizing publicly available information,
- identifying gaps in an analysis,
- improving writing clarity,
- creating visual drafts,
- supporting coding tasks,
- exploring alternative scenarios,
- preparing executive presentations.

These uses are consistent with the role of AI as a professional decision-support tool.

Inappropriate Uses of Artificial Intelligence

The following practices are inconsistent with the expectations of this course:

- Submitting AI-generated work without meaningful intellectual contribution.
- Fabricating citations or references.
- Citing sources that have not been consulted.
- Presenting AI-generated analyses as independently developed scholarship.
- Uploading confidential organizational information to unauthorized AI services.
- Using AI to circumvent assigned learning activities.
- Allowing AI to replace critical evaluation of strategic alternatives.

Professional integrity requires students to remain intellectually engaged throughout the learning process.

AI Disclosure Statement

Major assignments should include a brief statement describing the role of AI in the preparation of the work.

A suggested format is:

Artificial Intelligence Disclosure

Artificial intelligence tools were used to support brainstorming, literature exploration, editing, and preliminary analysis. All AI-generated outputs were independently evaluated, verified using scholarly sources, and substantially revised. The author accepts full responsibility for the accuracy, originality, and conclusions presented in this submission.

The purpose of this disclosure is transparency rather than evaluation.

Prompt Documentation

Students are encouraged to maintain a personal record of significant AI interactions throughout the semester.

Documenting prompts, revisions, and reflections helps students:

- evaluate the strengths and limitations of AI,
- improve prompt design,
- recognize potential biases,
- and develop reflective professional practice.

Selected assignments may require students to submit representative prompts as part of their learning portfolio.

Intellectual Property

Students should respect intellectual property rights when using AI systems.

This includes:

- complying with software licenses,
- respecting copyright,
- properly attributing external sources,
- avoiding unauthorized reproduction of protected materials,
- and acknowledging collaborative contributions where appropriate.

Responsible AI use includes responsible stewardship of intellectual property.

Professional Conduct

Students are expected to conduct themselves in a manner consistent with the standards of management consulting and executive leadership.

Professional expectations include:

- preparation for class,
- respectful dialogue,
- constructive disagreement,
- timely completion of assignments,
- evidence-based reasoning,
- openness to feedback,
- collaborative teamwork,
- ethical decision making,
- and continuous professional development.

The classroom is viewed as a professional learning community rather than solely an academic environment.

Responsible Leadership in the Age of AI

Artificial intelligence changes the nature of managerial work, but it does not diminish the importance of leadership.

Indeed, as AI becomes more capable, human responsibilities become more—not less—important.

Strategic leaders remain accountable for:

- organizational purpose,
- stakeholder relationships,
- ethical judgment,
- governance,
- resource allocation,
- and the long-term consequences of organizational decisions.

Throughout this course, students are encouraged to view AI as a powerful strategic partner whose value depends upon thoughtful human oversight, disciplined reasoning, and responsible leadership.

Course Commitment

By participating in this course, students commit to using artificial intelligence in a manner that reflects the values of scholarship, professionalism, transparency, and ethical leadership.

The objective is not merely to learn how to use AI.

The objective is to become the kind of strategic leader who knows **when** to rely on AI, **when** to question it, and **when** human judgment must prevail.

These habits of responsible practice will remain valuable long after today's AI technologies have evolved into tomorrow's.